

Murchha and Sanyasa

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मूर्च्छा (Mūrcchā)

Introduction

Mūrcchā is an indisposition characterised by the transient loss of consciousness. In this case, the patient may become conscious after sometime even without a treatment. Syncope, Loss of senses. When, in a person because of emaciation, excessive accumulation of *doṣa*, indulgence in mutually contradictory food, suppression of manifested natural urges, injury and weakness of mind, aggravated *doṣa* enter into the seats of external and internal *Indriyās* (motor and sensory organs) then he faints. When the channels carrying sensation (*Sajñāvaha nāḍī*) get obstructed by *vāyu* etc. darkness appears all of a sudden and the afflicted person becomes incapable of experiencing favourable and unfavourable stimulations as a result of which he falls like a log of wood. This condition is called *moha* (unconsciousness) and *mūrcchā* (fainting). This is of six categories.

There are six varieties of *Mūrcchā*. They are called *Vātika mūrcchā*, *Paittika mūrcchā*, *Kaphaja mūrcchā*, *Sannipātika mūrcchā*, *Raktaja mūrcchā*, *Viśaja* and *Madhyaja mūrcchā* depending on the causes involved. In all these varieties, *pitta* plays an important role. Pain in cardiac region, yawning, *glāni* (drowsiness and feeling of heaviness in the cardiac region) and loss of consciousness-these are the premonitory signs and symptoms of *mūrcchā* (fainting). Thereafter, the specific variety of the disease is manifested.

मूर्च्छा हेतु (Mūrcchā Hetu)

क्षीणस्य बहुदोषस्य विरुद्धाहारसेविनः ।
वेगाघातादभीघाताद्धीनसत्त्वस्य वा नः ॥
करणायतनेषूरा बाह्येष्वभ्यन्तरेषु च ।
निविशन्ते यदा दोषास्तदा मूर्च्छन्ति मानवाः ॥

S.S.Utt. 46/3-4

Persons who are emaciated, in whom the *Doṣās* greatly aggravated, one who consume incompatible

foods, suppression of natural urges, who are injured, & those who are mentally inferior.

मूर्च्छा संप्राप्ति (Mūrcchā Samprāpti)

Due to above etiological factors *Doṣās* become greatly exacerbated and accumulate in both the external & internal sense organs resulting into the development of *Mūrcchā*.

Nidāna Sevana (Consumption of Etiological factors)

↓
Aggravation of *Vātādi Doṣās*

↓
Doṣās accumulate in both the external & internal sense organs

↓
Amalgamation of *Doṣās* & *Dūṣyās* in the external & internal rogas

↓
Mūrcchā

मूर्च्छा पूर्वरूप (Mūrcchā Pūrvarūpa)

हृत्पीडा जृम्भणं ग्लानिः संज्ञानाशो बलस्य च ।
सर्वासां पूर्वरूपाणि, यथास्वं ता विभावयेत् ॥

S.S.Utt. 46/8

Premonitory signs & symptoms of *Mūrcchā* are pain in the heart, yawning, exhaustion, loss of consciousness & strength.

प्रत्यात्म लक्षण (Pratyātma Lakṣaṇa)

संज्ञावहासु नाडीषु पिहितास्वनिलादिभिः ।
तमोऽभ्युपैति सहसा सुखदुःखव्यपोहकृत् ॥
सुखदुःखव्यपोहाच्च नरः पतति काष्ठवत् ।
मोहो मूर्च्छेति तां प्राहुः ॥

S.S.Utt. 46/5-6

Due to obstruction in the *Sajñāvaha Srotas* by the increased *Vātādi Doṣās*, then *Tamas* (darkness) enhances greatly & destroys the feeling of the happiness & misery; by the destruction of feeling of comfort & discomfort, the person falls on the

ground like a log of wood is known as *Moha* or *Murchā*.

षड्विधा सा प्रकीर्तिता ॥
वातादिभिः शोणितेन मद्येन च विषेण च ।
षट्स्वप्नेतासु पित्तं हि प्रभुत्वेनावतिष्ठते ॥
S.S.Utt. 46/6-8

It is of six varieties i.e.

i) *Vātaja*, ii) *Pittaja*, iii) *Kaphaja*, iv) *Raktaja*
v) *Madhyaja* vi) *Viśaja*. Among all types *Pitta* is
the predominant *Doṣa*

वातज मूर्च्छा (Vātaja Murchā)

नीलं वा यदि वा कृष्णमाकाशमथवाऽरुणम् ।
पश्यंस्तमः प्रविशति शीघ्रं च प्रतिबुध्यते ॥
वेपथुश्चाङ्गमर्दश्च प्रपीडा हृदयस्य च ।
कार्श्यं श्यावाऽरुणाच्छाया मूर्च्छाये वातसंभवे ॥
M.Ni. 17/7-8

Vātaja Murchā patients sees the sky in blue, black or crimson colours, goes into darkness, falls down unconscious but regains consciousness quickly, tremors, general malaise, severe pain in the heart, emaciation and blackish red discolouration of the body.

पित्तज मूर्च्छा (Pittaja Murchā)

रक्तं हरितवर्णं वा वियत्पीतमथापि वा ।
पश्यंस्तमः प्रविशति सस्वेदश्च प्रबुध्यते ॥
संपिपासः ससन्तापो रक्तपीताकुलेक्षणः ।
जातमात्रे पतति च शीघ्रं च प्रतिबुध्यते ।
संभिन्नवर्चाः पीताभो मूर्च्छाये पित्तसंभवे ॥
M.Ni. 17/9-10

Pittaja Murchā patients sees sky appearing as red, green or yellow colours, loss of consciousness and regaining it after perspiration, (Thirst, increased body temperature, eyes red or yellow, loss of consciousness & quick regaining) diarrhoea & yellowish discolouration of the body.

कफज मूर्च्छा (Kaphaja Murchā)

मेघसंकाशमाकाशमावृतं वा तमोघनैः ।
पश्यंस्तमः प्रविशति चिराच्च प्रतिबुध्यते ॥
गुरुभिः प्रावृत्तैरङ्गैर्यथैवाद्र्देण चर्मणा ।
सप्रसेकः सहल्लासो मूर्च्छाये कफसंभवे ॥
M.Ni. 17/11-12

Kaphaja Murchā patients sees the sky full of

thick clouds, falls unconscious, regains consciousness after long time, feels as though his body is covered with heavy moist leather, salivation & nausea.

सन्निपातज मूर्च्छा (Sannipātaja Murchā)

सर्वाकृतिः सन्निपातादपस्मार इवागतः ।
स जन्तुं पातयत्याशु विना वीभत्सचेष्टितैः ॥
M.Ni. 17/13

Sannipātaja Murchā patients develops symptoms of all the three *Doṣās*, symptomatology mimic *Apasmāra* but without *Bibhatsaceṣṭā*.

रक्तज मूर्च्छा (Raktaja Murchā)

पृथिव्यम्भस्तमोरूपं रक्तगन्धश्च तन्मयः ।
तस्माद्रक्तस्य गन्धेन मूर्च्छन्ति भुवि मानवाः ।
द्रव्यस्वभाव इत्येके दृष्ट्वा यदभिमुह्यति ॥
S.S.Utt. 46/10

Rakta is composed of *Pṛthvi* & *Āpa Bhūtās* which have predominant *Tamogūṇa*. Some patients become unconscious & fall to the ground after seeing & smelling the blood. Some people attribute it as the specific property of blood.

रक्तज मूर्च्छा (Raktaja Murchā)/विषज मूर्च्छा (Viśaja Murchā)/मद्यज मूर्च्छा (Madhyaja Murchā)

गुणास्तीव्रतरत्वेन स्थितास्तु विषमद्ययोः ॥
त एव तस्मात्ताभ्यां तु मोहौ स्यातां यथेरितौ ।
सत्त्वाङ्गदृष्टिसत्त्वसृजा गूढोच्छ्वासश्च मूर्च्छितः ॥
मद्येन विलपज्जते नष्टविभ्रान्तमानसः ।
गात्राणि विक्षिपन् भूमौ जरां यावन्न याति तत् ॥
M.Ni. 7/15-17

Stiffness of the body & fixed gaze are observed in *Raktaja Murchā*.

Inconsistent speech, falling on the ground with loss of mental activities, abnormal movements of the body, these symptoms disappear soon after the digestion of alcohol are the characteristic features of *Madhyaja Murchā*. *Madhyaja Murchā* is caused by poisonous & alcohol drinks having profound symptoms. Tremors, sleep, thirst & feeling of darkness & other symptoms specific to the particular poisonous substances are the characteristic features of *Viśaja Murchā*.

Predominance of Doṣās in Mūrchā, Bhrama, Tandra & Nidrā

मूर्च्छा पित्ततमः प्राया रजःपित्तानिलाद् भ्रमः ।
तमोवातकफात्तन्द्रा निद्रा श्लेष्मतमो भवा ॥

M.Ni. 17/19

Mūrchā is caused by predominance of Pitta & Tamas; Bhrama is caused by Rajas, Pitta & Vāta. Tandrā manifest due to predominance of Tamas, Vāta & Kapha. Nidrā is caused by predominance of Kapha & Tamas.

भ्रम रोग (Bhrama Roga)

चक्रवद् भ्रमतो गात्रं भूमौ पतति सर्वदा ।
भ्रमरोग इति ज्ञेयो रजःपित्तानिलात्मकः ॥

M.Ni. 17/19

Bhrama Roga is characterised by reeling of a body like a turning wheel & person falls on the ground regularly. It manifest due to predominance of Raja, Pitta & Vāta.

तन्द्रा (Tandrā)

इन्द्रियार्थेष्वसंवेत्तिर्गौरवं जृम्भणं क्लमः ।
निद्रार्तस्येव यस्येहा तस्य तन्द्रां विनिर्दिशेत् ॥

M.Ni. 17/20

Tandrā is characterised by non perception of their objects by the sense organs, heaviness, yawning, feeling exhaust without performing any physical activities & person appears like sleeping.

सन्यास (Sannyāsa)

प्रभूतदोषस्तमसोऽतिरेकात्सम्मूर्च्छितो नैव विबुध्यते यः ।
संन्यस्तसंज्ञो भृशदुश्चिकित्स्यो ज्ञेयस्तदा बुद्धिमता मनुष्यः ॥

S.S.Utt. 46/21

Sannyāsa manifest due to excacerbation of Doṣās or of predominance of Tamogūṇa and it is characterised by non awakening state or unconsciousness. It is difficult for treatment.

दोषेषु मदमूर्च्छायाः कृतवेगेषु देहिनाम् ।
स्वयमेवोपशाम्यन्ति, संन्यासो नौषधैर्विना ॥
वाग्देहमनसां चेष्टामाक्षिप्यातिबला मलाः ।
संन्यासं सन्निपतिताः प्राणायतनसंश्रयाः ॥
कुर्वन्ति, तेन पुरुषः काष्ठीभूतो मृतोपमः ।
म्रियेत शीघ्रं शीघ्रं चेच्चिकित्सा न प्रयुज्यते ॥

अगाधे ग्राह्यहुले सलिलीघ इवातटे ।
संन्यासे विनिमज्जन्तं नरमाशु निवर्तयेत् ॥

A.H.Ni. 6/36-39

Patient regain consciousness soon after bouts of attacks in case of Mūrchā & Mada. However in case of Sannyāsa patient does not regain consciousness without treatment.

Excessively excacerbated powerful Doṣās invade the seats of Prāṇāyatana and brings about impairment of the speech, body & mind. Patients appears like a log of wood & a dead man. If it is not managed immediately patient dies soon.

Patients of Sannyāsa is sinking in the ocean of Sannyāsa which is very deep infested with many crocodiles, having huge waves & no shore should be abandoned soon.

उपशय/पथ्य (Upāśaya/Pathya)

The following activities are advisable for a patient suffering from the disease of Mūrchā (syncope): smoking (herbal ingredients), applying Añjana to eye lids, nasal treatment, cauterization, prickling with needles, pulling the hair, causing pain beneath his nail plates, cutting him by teeth, closing the passage of his nose and mouth so that breathing is checked, allowing him to vomit, to fast, frightening him or showing anger to him, putting him on a bed upon which he could not sleep properly, telling him pleasing stories, placing him under cool shadows, rain water, applying the Ghṛtam over his forehead, etc. The patient should take hot syrup prepared by the fresh rice-grains, old barley, the Śālī variety of red rice-grains, the old Ghṛtam (kept in some earthen pitcher), the syrup of the peas and Mudga (green gram), juice of meat of the animal and birds from the Jāṅgala regions, the pickles and confectioneries, cow milk, sugar candy, old ash pumpkin, leaves of Paṭola, banana, Harītakī, grains that are easily digestible, water of wells located by the side of rivers, white sandalwood and water treated with camphor. The sands of the river land, sounds, show of strange items, singing loudly and making large instrumental sounds before the patients, all these are helpful items in cases of syncope. One is also advised to remind the patient of the lost family members, of

the lost memories, his self-knowledge and to make the patient gain consolation, etc. (B.R. 21/22-27)

अनुपश्य/अपथ्य (Anupaśaya/Apathya)

The items to be avoided while suffering from *Mūrcchā* (syncope) includes the eatables like the betel leaves, leaves of mustard saplings, buttermilk, etc. and such acts as using the tooth-sticks to clean the tooth, facing the sun, taking incompatible meals, having intercourse, sweating, taking bitter items, holding the urge of thirst and sleep. (B.R. 21/28)

MCQs

1. आहारपरिणामान्तेभूयश्चलभतेबलम is clinical feature of
a. व्यपेताहिकका (Vyapeta Hikk
b. Paithikamuricha
c. Dwitiyamada
d. Dhvamsaka
2. *Apasmara iva patatyasu nischeshtam vinabhehtsa ceshtitaihi* is the feature of
a. Vishajamada
b. Tridoshajamurcha
c. Sanyasa
d. Tritiyamada
3. *Kashtibhoothomritopamama* is the feature of
a. Tritiyamada
b. Vikshaya
c. Sanyasa
d. Madyajamada
4. Number of *Madatyaya upadrava* as per *Madavanidana*
a. 4
b. 7
c. 10
d. 11
5. *Pretasahabhakshanam* in *Svapna* is seen in
a. Jwara
b. Udara
c. Apasmaram
d. Madatyaya
6. Which among the following is not the *Guna* of *Madhya*
a. Amla
b. Katu
c. Ruksha
d. Sukshma
7. *Nischeshtashavavat shete* is the feature of
a. Tridoshajamurcha
b. Tridoshaja Madatyaya
c. 3rd stage of mada
d. Sanyasa
8. *Srotas* involved in the *samprapthi* of *Mada*, *Murcha* & *Sanyasa*
a. Mamsa, Meda & Satwa
b. Asthi, Majja & Chetana
c. Shukra, Majja & Manas
d. Rasa, Raktha & Chetana
9. *Meghasankasam pasyanaakasham* is the feature of which *murcha*
a. Vata
b. Pitta
c. Kapha
d. Tridoshaja
10. *Dosha* predominance of *Sanyasa*
a. Vata- Kaphaja
b. Vata - Pittaja
c. Tridoshaja
d. Kapha - Pittaja
11. *Agade graha bahula salilougha ivaathare* is told about
a. Mada
b. Madatyaya
c. Murcha
d. Sanyasa

Answer

1. a	2. b	3. c
4. b	5. d	6. b
7. c	8. d	9. c
10. c	11. d	